

Section 02

Industrial Security (Bachelor)



Section 02 – ICS and SCADA Fundamentals

ICS and SCADA Fundamentals

Lecture Notes

Department of Computer Science

1 Control Loop and Field Devices

2 Plant-Wide Architectures

3 Safety Layer

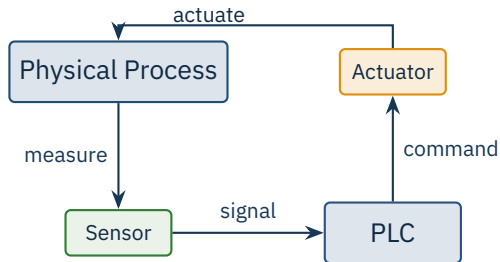
By the end of this section you will be able to

- Identify the components of a typical industrial control loop.
- Distinguish PLC, RTU, DCS, SCADA, HMI, Historian, and SIS.
- Explain the scan cycle and determinism requirements of PLCs.
- Read a simple ladder-logic program.
- Recognise why Safety Instrumented Systems must remain independent.

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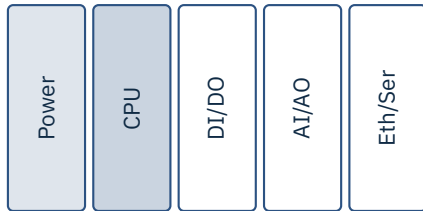
Control Loop and Field Devices

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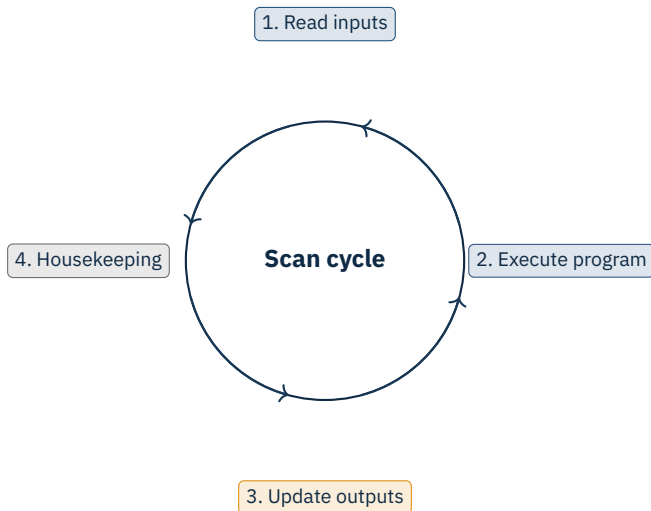


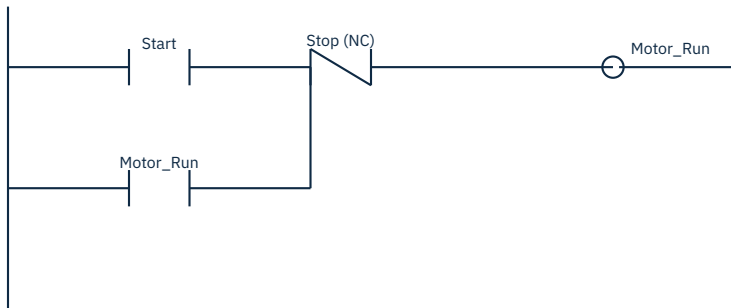
Cycle:
10 μ s – 100 ms
Deterministic

- Ruggedised industrial computer
- First model: Modicon 084 (1969)
- Replaced relay logic in plants
- IEC 61131-3 languages:
 - Ladder Diagram (LD)
 - Structured Text (ST)
 - Function Block (FBD)
 - Sequential Function Chart
 - Instruction List



Source: D. Morley, "History of the PLC", Modicon, 2003 | IEC 61131-3:2013.



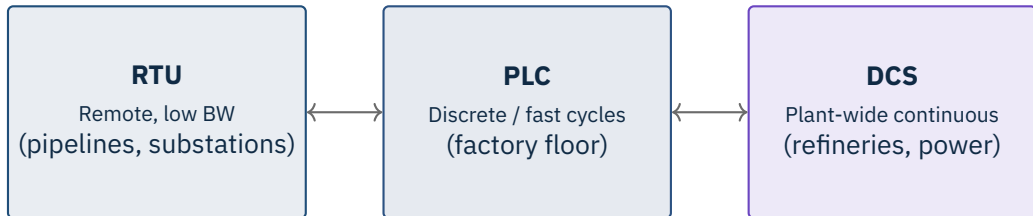


Pressing Start energises the coil; rung 2 latches it. Stop (NC) breaks both paths.

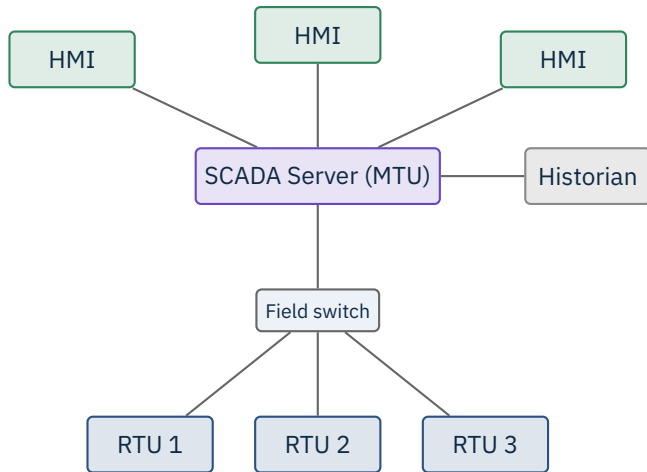
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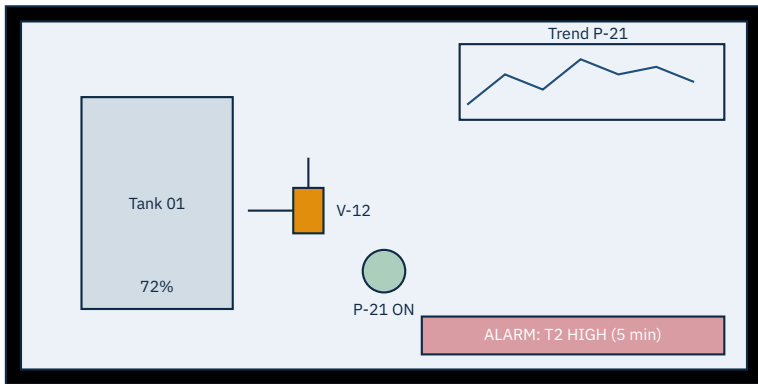
Plant-Wide Architectures

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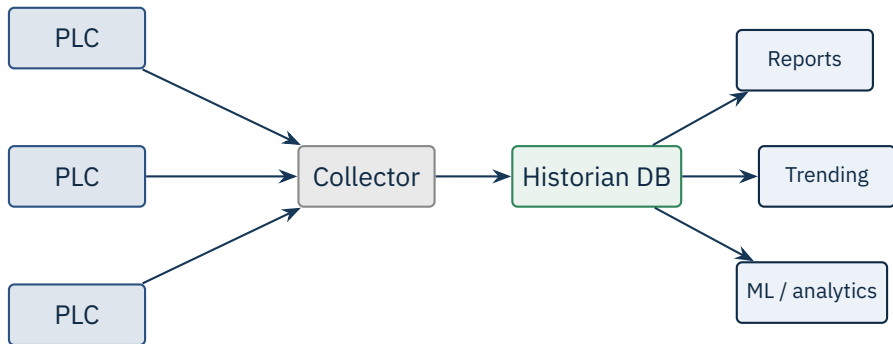


The boundary blurs in modern systems.





Mimic diagrams, trends, alarm bars. Bad HMI design = accidents (Three Mile Island, 1979).

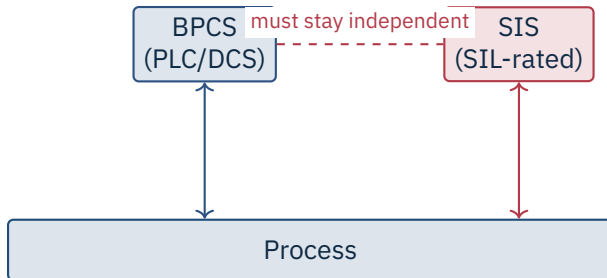


Historians bridge OT and IT; a frequent pivot point for attackers.

3

Safety Layer

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Safety layer

The SIS brings the process to a safe state on demand. **IEC 61511 / 61508**, SIL 1–4.

Source: IEC 61508 (2010, ed. 2.0), IEC 61511 (2016–17, ed. 2.0) | TRITON: Dragos TRISIS Malware Analysis, 2017.



The big two in the wild

LD dominates discrete manufacturing; ST is the cross-vendor portable choice for new development.



Caution

Why attackers love it The engineering WS holds the credentials, project files, and the ability to *re-flash logic*. Treat it as the crown jewel of the plant.

Type	Examples	Control system flavour
Continuous	Refinery, power, water	DCS, tight feedback control
Batch	Pharma, food, chemicals	DCS + recipe management (ISA-88)
Discrete	Auto assembly, packaging	PLCs, fast cycle, ladder logic

Why this matters for security

Different processes have different “safe states” – shutdown is fine for discrete, may be catastrophic for continuous. IR plans must reflect that.

★ Key Takeaway: What to remember from this section

- Control loops close from sensors through PLC/DCS to actuators.
- SCADA aggregates field data; HMIs deliver situational awareness.
- Historians are the long-term memory and a common IT/OT bridge.
- SIS must remain independent — attacking it was TRITON's goal in 2017.

End of Section 02

ICS and SCADA Fundamentals

Questions and discussion